

An open letter to students and parents

Dear Students & Parents,

Education has become one BIG business today. Gullible students and their equally anxious parents are lured with fancy promises, glossy brochures, free laptops, foreign trips et al.

Make sure you thoroughly check out the credentials of the institution, before you commit your precious time and money.

Don't forget to ask these questions: Who are the promoters? What is their background and track record? Are they outstanding achievers and eminent educationists who have carved a niche in the academic arena? Or are they just a bunch of street-smart businessmen looking to make a quick buck?

Branding them as "commercial ventures", the UGC and MHRD is cracking the whip on the so-called "study centres" of varsities offering courses through distance learning.

Education is a major investment of time and money. And like making any investment, make sure you ask the right questions and read the fine print. Caveat Emptor!

It is essential that you do a reality check by personally visiting institution where you may seek admission. Better be safe than sorry.

Here's wishing you the very best for a truly successful future.

Pervin Malhotra

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Pervin Malhotra is India's leading career columnist and career counselor. Her advise to students and parents is the first in this series sponsored by SelaQui Academy of Higher Education, Dehradun.

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